ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	19th Commission Meeting
DATE:	04 March 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	Monthly update on the Escrow Account – DoPS *EMD apprised the Commission on the status of the Escrow Account for the month of February 2026 with an opening and closing balance of Nu. 35,386,625.96 and Nu. 35,914,361.96 respectively.* *During the reporting month, the EMD received a total sum of Nu. 527,736.00 into the account. Of this, Nu. 122,736.00 was collected as administrative sanctions, which involved five individuals across three separate cases. The remaining amount, Nu. 405,000.00, was attributed to bail and bond receipts.* *The latter amount was subsequently withdrawn with the intention of returning it to the concerned party. However, the release has been withheld following a request from the OAG to retain the amount for settlement against the restitution order in the same case.* *While highlighting the types of funds maintained with the Escrow Account, the EMD sought the guidance from the Commission concerning the appropriate method for disposing of USD notes held in the account, noting that prolonged retention would result in the series becoming older and potentially not being accepted by the Banks in the future.*	**Noted the fund status and directed the following:** • **release the bail amount after reconfirming the legal position that the bail and bond executed by the ACC cease upon the filing of the charges in the Court.** • **review the classification of seized cash and identify an appropriate terminology.** • **seek advice from the RMA on the possibility of opening a foreign currency account to minimize the risk associated with demonetization or non-acceptance of older USD series.** • **present an updated status on the total funds surrendered during the next Commission meeting.**
2	Update on the ADA training – DoPE *ADMD apprised the Commission on the training conducted for ADAs from 21-29 January 2026, which focused on the legal framework governing asset declarations, the roles and responsibilities of ADAs, and familiarization with the online ADS. Out of a total of 169 ADAs, including 41 newly appointed ADAs, 123 participants attended the training, comprising 39 of the 41 new ADAs. Of these, 36 participants who had previously attended the programme joined virtually,*	**Noted the update and directed to present a comprehensive proposal on the enhancement of the ADS, highlighting proposed new features, particularly on data analytics, while also addressing the existing system gaps.**

	while 87 participants attended the face-to-face sessions conducted in three batches in Thimphu and one in Trashigang. The total expenditure incurred for the training amounted to Nu. 0.228 million. In addition, the programme also included training on the IVS for the respective focal persons. *Further, ADMD apprised the Commission on the recurring instability of the ADS, particularly during the declaration period, which requires frequent technical troubleshooting. In this regard, ADMD sought the Commission's approval to extend the AMC for an additional year, with the understanding that internal technical capacity would be built during this period. While some system enhancements were also proposed, these have been deferred due to budget constraints. To this, the Commission emphasized the enhancement of the ADS is necessary not only to enable advanced data analytics and related functions, considering the rich dataset maintained within the system, but also in view of its growing relevance as a benchmark platform increasingly looked up to by regional and international counterparts.*	
3	Update on the OIP implementation & AIMS framework – DoPE *PD apprised the Commission on the status of monitoring and evaluation of OIPs. Currently, nine OIPs are under active monitoring, comprising three arising from system studies, four from post investigation systemic recommendations, and two from CRM initiated in agencies.* *In terms of progress, all 13 systemic recommendations under the Timber Extraction and Export through Scientific Thinning study have been fully implemented. Of the 10 systemic recommendations under the Bailey Bridge Construction, eight have been fully implemented while two remain under implementation. For the Tourism Sector system study, which provided 17 systemic recommendations, a mid-term review is scheduled for April 2026. With regard to post investigation systemic recommendations issued to agencies including MoHA, DRC, RRCO, STCBL, DoST, Mother & Child Hospital, and BBS, the mid-term reviews conducted for DRC and STCBL indicate implementation progress of 52% and 85% respectively.* *Additionally, PD presented the revised AIMS framework, which comprises two components with the following indicators and weightage:* *1) **Integrity Promotion (80 points)**:* *a) Internal Corruption Control Systems (32 points)*	**Noted with following specific directives:** • **ensure rigorous scrutiny during monitoring to ascertain the actual implementation of systemic recommendations, with continuous follow-up over six or twelve months as appropriate.** • **validate the relevance and practical implementability of the recommendations provided to agencies during the monitoring process.** • **accord due consideration to the efforts made by Head Offices in facilitating implementation of recommendations at field offices.** • **categorize recommendations based on the expected implementation timeline, such as within six months or beyond, depending on their nature and complexity.**

	b) *Integrity Capacity Building (24 points)* c) *Asset Declaration Compliance (14 points)* d) *Code of Conduct Awareness and Application (10 points)* 2) ***Corruption Accountability (20 points)**:* a) *Corruption Case Severity (20 points)* *The indicators under Integrity Promotion will be assessed across three maturity levels viz. foundational, established, and advanced while the Corruption Accountability component will be measured based on the severity of corruption cases.*	• **ensure that recommendations primarily focus on areas requiring integrity enhancement rather than general operational issues of the systems or agencies.** • **follow up with the MoHA on the implementation of systemic recommendations issued as part of the post investigation referrals to the Ministry.** • **devise an appropriate maturity level classification for agencies that have not initiated actions under indicators within the Integrity Promotion Component.** • **seek feedback from agencies on the proposed severity scoring under the Corruption Accountability Component.**
4	Research proposal from Prof. Melinda Edwards – DoPE *EAD apprised the Commission on a proposal received from Prof. Melinda Edwards and Dr. Ping to undertake a joint research study titled "**Understanding the Normalisation of Corruption in Bhutan**". The proposal was developed based on the preliminary concept note shared by the ACC on emerging signals of corruption normalisation, as reflected through repetitive corruption scandals and integrity violations observed in the same agencies or sectors despite sustained prevention and deterrence efforts by the ACC.* *Drawing on relevant corruption theories and global case studies, EAD highlighted that the study would provide an in depth understanding of the genesis and drivers of corruption in Bhutan, particularly in relation to the country's cultural context, societal norms, and public attitudes towards corruption. The research would also contribute to strengthening local capacity in conducting advanced qualitative research methods, including ethnographic based analysis, an area where experience in Bhutan remains limited. Further, the findings are expected to generate insights that could enhance the effectiveness of the ACC's existing anti-corruption and integrity tools by*	**Endorsed with following specific directives:** • **ensure strong local counterpart from the ACC to provide oversight including quality control and editorial review.** • **explore further negotiation on the proposed professional fees.**

	shedding light on emerging corruption typologies in the country. *If approved, the research is proposed to commence from mid-April 2026. Prof. Melinda Edwards has expressed willingness to contribute on a pro bono basis, while concessional professional fees of AUD 15,000.00 have been proposed for Dr. Ping, who will serve as the lead researcher, in addition to covering local logistical expenses during the experts' one-month engagement. To this, given that the proposed activity is unbudgeted, PPD sought Commission's directive on exploring the possibility of deferring the payment in the next financial year.* *While supporting the proposal in principle, the Commission underscored the importance of ensuring strong quality control to prevent any misrepresentation or misinterpretation in the analysis and reporting, particularly when examining cultural enablers and systemic vulnerabilities.*	
5	Update on the Capstone Project with GCIT and Electronic Signature Application – DoI & SS *DoI and SS apprised the Commission on the scope and status of the Operational Command Control System (O2CS), which was initially developed by GCIT students under the Capstone Programme. However, the system could not be completed within the Capstone period due to the additional time required to explore integration of third-party hardware such as body cameras, GPS trackers, and drones. These technologies are expected to provide enhanced operational support during investigations and tactical field operations. In this regard, DoI informed that policy advice is currently being sought from the MoIT regarding the use of drones for such purposes.* *With the graduation of the students who had undertaken the project under the Capstone Programme, DoI proposed retaining their services on a short-term basis to complete the remaining components of the O2CS, with a proposed engagement fee of Nu. 0.200 million. It was also shared that GCIT has selected the O2CS as one of the projects to be showcased during the upcoming Capstone Tech Innovation Showcase 2026.* *Additionally, DoI submitted that the budget allocated for installing interview recording systems in the remaining two interview rooms is insufficient, and therefore proposed re-appropriating the above allocated budget towards completing and operationalizing the O2CS.* *Further, SS presented an internally developed Electronic Signature Application designed to minimize*	**Endorsed with following directives:** • **communicate the reasons for the inability to complete the capstone project within the stipulated period and sensitize the GCIT on the need to facilitate completion such projects.** • **review the appropriateness of showcasing the O2CS during the upcoming Tech Innovation Showcase.** • **integrate the Electronic Signature Application with internal systems to be used for all documents and present once again before adoption.**

	recurring subscription costs associated with commercial or open-source platforms. SS sought the Commission's approval for its adoption and implementation.	
5	Invitation to Co-Chair 8th Meeting of the Asia and the Pacific LEN – PPD *OECD extended an invitation for Commissioner Gyeltshen to Co-Chair the 8th Meeting of the Asia and the Pacific Law Enforcement Meeting (LEN), which is scheduled on 12 May 2026 at Tashkent, Uzbekistan. The meeting will focus on following two areas:* - *use of technology and data analytics to detect and investigate transnational corruption cases; and* - *conducting financial investigations in corruption and bribery cases.* *To this, PPD is currently exploring with the Anti-Corruption Initiative Secretariat on the nomination of additional member from the ACC to attend the meeting. To this, considering the focus area of the meeting, Commissioner Gyeltshen proposed for sharing the ACC's experience of employing AI based BSA as one of the tools for investigation and related purposes.*	**Endorsed.**
	Others - Update on the Integrity Vetting System (IVS) *CFD presented demo of the enhanced version of the IVS, showcasing the dashboard for respective users, application process, review workflow, validation mechanism, and report generation format.* - Follow up on the visit by the Hon'ble Chief Justice *The Commission emphasized the importance of presenting the internal IT systems in the ACC before the formal launch of the Justice Sector Digital Blueprint to the Hon'ble Chief Justice. Further, the meeting can be optimized to also brief on the findings of the TI CPI 2025, particularly those trends concerning the Judiciary.* - Visit to the Regional Offices *Highlighting the long pending visit to the Regional Offices, the Commission emphasized the need to optimize the visit by interacting with the relevant stakeholders involved in implementing youth integrity and related anti-corruption programmes to further reinforce the collective action against corruption.*	**Noted with the directive to integrate with the CIMS to ensure reliability of data. Further, directed to revisit the language 'as regards' used in the IVR.** **Directed PPD to follow up on the visit.** **Directed PPD to explore the visit towards the end of March 2026.**

	- Yoga Sessions for the ACC staff *The Commission discussed on the readiness from the Embassy of India, Thimphu to conduct the Yoga session irrespective of the number of participants.*	**Directed HRS to contact Mr. Aniket Mandavgane, Deputy Chief of Mission at Embassy of India, Thimphu for the sessions**

Commissioner - *Official Tour* - **Commissioner** **Chairperson**